

HOUSE RESOLUTION 169

By Love

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Dr. Carolyn Baldwin Tucker for her contributions to the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this legislative body should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is Dr. Carolyn Baldwin Tucker, a highly respected member of her community who has dedicated herself to improving the quality of life for her fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Carolyn Baldwin Tucker is the youngest of nine children born to George and Susie Baldwin in Chattanooga; and

WHEREAS, after the passing of her father when she was five years old and her mother on her eleventh birthday, Dr. Tucker was reared by one of her older sisters, Mrs. Jewell Baldwin Cousin; she graduated from Howard High School in 1965 at the age of seventeen; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Tucker enrolled at Tennessee A&I State University in the fall of 1965, pledged to the Alpha Chi Chapter of Delta Sigma Theta Sorority, Incorporated, in 1966, and earned her Bachelor of Science degree in Elementary Education from Tennessee State University (TSU) in 1969; and

WHEREAS, while in college, Dr. Carolyn Tucker met her wonderful, loving, and devoted husband, Elder Jesse F. Tucker, and the two were married in the fall of 1969; to that union, two children were born, Attorney Susan Tucker Jones and Evangelist Randall F. Tucker; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Tucker, a lifelong learner, continued her education, earning her master's degree from TSU in 1971, her Education Specialist Degree from the University of Tennessee,

Knoxville, in 1977, and her Ph.D. from George Peabody College of Vanderbilt University in 1982; and

WHEREAS, for thirty years, Dr. Carolyn Tucker was employed by Metro Nashville Public Schools, where she served five years as a classroom teacher, twenty-two years as a principal, and three years as an elementary schools director; she also served as interim director of schools for Murfreesboro City Schools during the 2009-2010 school year; and

WHEREAS, for sixteen years, Dr. Tucker served as a visiting professor at Lipscomb University and as Lipscomb's Director of Graduate Studies in Education for two years; even in retirement, she continued to serve our great State by accepting a role as an exemplary educator for the Tennessee Department of Education; and

WHEREAS, as a continuous influence for women, her family, and her community, by the grace of God, Dr. Carolyn Tucker was elected to the Metro Council in 1999, becoming the first African-American woman to win a county-wide race in the history of Nashville and Davidson County and the first African-American woman to be elected as an At-Large member of the Metro Council; as a result of this accomplishment, she has been recognized by the City of Nashville with a street named in her honor; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Tucker, as an educator concerned about the issues affecting families within the State of Tennessee, served as an expert consultant for the late Senator Avon N. Williams to sponsor legislation to provide guidance counselors in elementary schools across the state, the passage and impact of which continues to help students traverse and cope with life, family, and systemic challenges; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Carolyn Tucker and her husband, who served the State of Tennessee as a counselor in the Department of Correction and later as an administrator within probation and parole, observed a need for educating the community regarding violence prevention, and in response, they offered and presented workshops on "Prevention Now or Correction Later"; and

WHEREAS, an active mother and educator committed to investing in the development of children, Dr. Tucker was asked by two members of the Tennessee Black Caucus of State Legislators to design a program for the youth of Tennessee, which would be an active component of the Annual Legislative Retreat of the Tennessee Black Caucus of State Legislators; she created the Youth Task Force, which she chaired for fifteen years, providing opportunities for youth across the state to engage with legislators and decision makers through panel discussions, essay contests, oratorical contests, and the Youth Luncheon; and

WHEREAS, being aware of the impact of youth violence on our communities, Carolyn Tucker worked with the Tennessee Black Caucus to conduct the "Stop the Violence Now" conferences for Tennessee youth; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Tucker is a woman of many talents; she has authored and sung country music songs and written two inspirational books for the Christian woman; she continues in service to the Lord, her family, and her community as a Ladies Bible Class facilitator and a Sunday School teacher at the Church of Christ at Jackson Street; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Carolyn Tucker epitomizes the spirit and commitment to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this legislative body acknowledge and applaud Dr. Tucker for her dedication to the State of Tennessee and its citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and commend Dr. Carolyn Baldwin Tucker for her lifetime of service to her community and the State of Tennessee and extend to her our best wishes for much continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.